

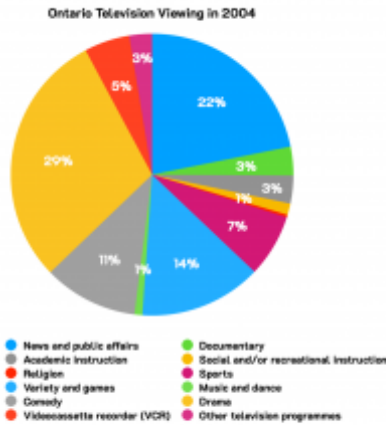


Figure 2.9. A pie chart displaying 12 categories of television viewing in Ontario in 2004 provides too much visual information, making it hard to read.

False Causation

Correlation does not imply causation.

If you've ever taken a statistics or data analysis course, you have almost certainly come across this common phrase. It means that, just because two trends seem to fluctuate alongside each other, it doesn't prove that one causes the other or that they are related in a meaningful way.

Review Figure 2.10²³ below, which shows a line graph of the

2. Statistics Canada. Table 37-10-0079-01 Registered apprenticeship training, registrations by major trade groups and sex. Data is reproduced and distributed on an "as is" basis with the permission of Statistics Canada. Retrieved February 2nd, 2022. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.25318/3710007901-eng>. Statistics Canada Open Licence: <https://www.statcan.gc.ca/en/reference/licence>
3. Statistics Canada. Table 32-10-0364-01 Area, production and farm gate